

Diesel export restrictions now unlikely

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Negative commodity and financial market reactions are pushing the US away from restricting diesel exports.|||||||

Quick take

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Export restrictions now unlikely in US response to diesel prices

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Short-term trajectory:

Long-term trajectory:

After building momentum last week, the push to implement restrictions on diesel exports stalled this weekend, with the administration now leaning towards voluntary measures rather than an imposed curb to exports. Discussions around the issue within the administration are chaotic, with all options remain at least partially on the table.

What Happened

Equity and commodity markets moved sharply in response to potential export curbs through Friday afternoon, and feedback late Friday and this weekend suggests greater internal division over the political attractiveness of an export curb.

Our Take

Eurasia Group no longer expects export curbs in early October (40%, down from 65%). Until late Friday, the politics lined up in favor of a partial export restriction as part of the administration's response to high diesel prices (see: [Likely US diesel export curb still a live debate](#) , 25 September 2026). Based on feedback from political and industry sources, the math has flipped, primarily due to negative commodity and financial market reactions, and we are revising our call to reflect this. We are not moving our odds further due to the confused and slightly chaotic nature of the internal debate on the administration's response, which leaves all options still at least partially on the table.

Voluntary reductions are likely to be part of an early week announcement. Secretary of Energy Chris Wright continues to pressure refiners to agree to voluntary export reductions, and the White House will likely include a voluntary reduction proposal when they roll out their initial response plan early this week. These reductions are not enforceable, however, and would create legal risk for refiners if implemented—both points suggesting they will not have a significant effect.

Implementation is a key tripping point. Our initial view that Bureau of Industry and Security (BIS) export licenses were the easiest method for imposing an export curb still holds. However, hesitation from within the Department of Commerce meant that the administration had to consider other options. The most obvious, imposing controls via the International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA),

comes with some substantial downside, namely, the risk of legal challenge and the severity of the tools used to force export reductions.

Talk of export curbs won't die completely. In addition to voluntary measures, the administration's response (the 60% base case) will likely include:

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Domestic policy changes, including reinstatement of blanket Jones Act waivers, relaxation of refinery regulations, and expanding the sale of off-road use diesel, which is untaxed.

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Diplomatic pressure on the EU to utilize its own refined product reserves.

Domestic policy changes are the most likely to come to fruition, though they are unlikely to bring prices down sufficiently to mollify the groups demanding immediate relief. The nature of the administration's internal debate means the idea of export curbs will likely resurface if prices continue to move higher.

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